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English presentative semantic patterns as seen through a parallel translation corpus

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The present paper studies the English presentative semantic pattern whose function is to introduce a new phenomenon into the discourse, relating it to an already established location. A contrastive (English-Czech) cross-linguistic corpus-assisted approach is applied to explore syntactically diverse forms which represent the same presentative semantic pattern: 'location – presentation verb – new phenomenon'. We focus on English sentences in which the location is expressed syntactically as the subject. The English constructions with a locative subject were detected as translation counterparts of Czech sentence-initial locative adverbials realized by prepositional phrases. Our study demonstrates that the potential of the sentence to introduce a new phenomenon in discourse is primarily based on the semantics of the verb.

Keywords: presentative semantic pattern, presentation verb, locative subject, local grammar, Czech/English

1. Introduction

In contrastive corpus-assisted studies the focus has recently shifted to the analysis of co-occurrence relations. "This new emphasis on the company words keep, to use Firth's expression, has led to the discovery of a wide range of word combinations or multi-word units, which vary in fixedness and idiomaticity" (Altenberg and Granger, 2002: 5; cf. also Ebeling and Oksefjell Ebeling, 2013: 50). We present a cross-linguistic study of the semantic pattern whose function is to introduce a new phenomenon or entity in the discourse situation, relating it to an already established location (cf. Johansson, 2007: 234–5). The semantic pattern explored here resembles Hunston's 'semantic sequences', i.e. recurrent "sequences of words and phrases that may be very diverse in form and which are therefore more usefully characterised as sequences of meaning elements rather than as formal

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sequences" (Hunston, 2008: 271). The English semantic pattern to be dealt with can be described as 'location – presentation verb – new phenomenon'.

In the present paper we focus on English sentences in which the location is expressed syntactically as the subject. The locative subjects were detected as translation counterparts of Czech sentence-initial locative adverbials realized by prepositional phrases with the prepositions *do* ("into"), *na* ("at/on"), *v/ve* ("in"), *z/ze* ("from") complemented by a noun. The sentences are analysed both from syntactic and semantic perspectives. From the syntactic point of view, the cross-linguistic approach makes it possible to identify a variety of formally distinct English sentences with a locative subject. From the semantic point of view, major attention is paid to the semantics of the verb, as it is the "semantic content of the verb that actuates the presentation semantics of the sentence" (Dušková, 2015: 260).

2. English presentative constructions

Several types of presentative sentences have received quite a lot of attention in the linguistic literature, in particular in connection with the topic-focus articulation (Lyons, 1967; Bolinger, 1977; Erdmann, 1990; Firbas, 1992; Adam, 2013; Dušková, 2015). Ebeling (2000) distinguishes three syntactic types of presentative constructions (cf. also Johansson, 2007):

- full (existential) presentative constructions:
  - There's **a long trip** ahead of us.
- bare presentative constructions with a rhematic subject:
  - **A long trip** is ahead of us.
  - Ahead of us is **a long trip**.
- *have*-constructions:
  - We have **a long trip** ahead of us.
  - The tree has **a nest** in it.

What the three presentative constructions have in common is that they all contain "an indefinite noun phrase which could be said to present the addressee with new or unknown information" (Ebeling, 2000: 1), and their basic communicative function is identical, i.e. to introduce, or present, a new referent into discourse, making it "discourse-active and ready for recall in subsequent sentences" (Lambrecht, 1994: 178). Depending on the grammatical structure, the new referent/phenomenon (*a long trip*, *a nest*) is introduced on the scene either as the subject or as the object.

In addition, Adam (2013) and Dušková (2015) point out that the bare presentative construction may occur with other, semantically weak, verbs performing the presentative function (viz. verbs of existence and appearance on the scene) (example 1).

(1) A slow cruel smile came over the Witch's face. (Adam, 2013: 66)

They also distinguish another type of presentative constructions, viz. sentences comprising a locative subject and a verb of existence or appearance on the scene (2).

(2) The road carries a lot of traffic. (Dušková, 2015: 206)

Example (2) illustrates a prototypical instance of this type of presentative construction. Syntactically, the English sentence displays the pattern 'subject-verb-object'. From the semantic point of view, the subject denotes location of where the state/process takes place; the verb expresses a kind of state or process, and the object can be described as the bearer of the state/process (cf. Kettnerová, 2014: 216), which represents the new phenomenon.

The repertoire of verbs occurring in the construction with a locative subject appears to be rather limited. They are typically monotransitive verbs exhibiting similar semantic features. Adam (2013: 150) points out that these verbs "seem to be quite general and auxiliary-like, denoting existence/appearance on the scene". They may even be considered "quasi-copulative for they merely provide a link between the participants in verbal action without contributing any relevant lexico-semantic feature" (Dušková, 1999b: 250). The verbs most frequently attested in the literature are *have* (3), *bear*, and *carry* (2).

(3) Inside, the cave was dark and cold and *had* the damp feel and smell of a place that had not been lived in for several days. (Adam, 2013: 149)[1]

Apart from the above sentences with monotransitive verbs, the locative subject is also found in constructions which have been described as resulting from 'locative alternation' (4a) (see Salkoff, 1983; Levin, 1993: 53–55; Dowty, 2000; Fried, 2005).

(4) a. *The garden* is swarming with bees.
b. Bees are swarming *in the garden*.

Locative alternation is a kind of syntactic-semantic alternation which involves both intransitive (4) and transitive verbs. In example (4) the two constructions

1. The choice of the construction with *have* (rather than the *there*-existental construcion) may be influenced by the tendency towards a constant subject in English.

differ in the assignment of semantic roles to the syntactic clause elements, i.e. valency complements of the verb (Panevová et al., 2014: 122–123): the role of location is assigned alternatively either to the subject (4a) or to the adverbial (4b). The two constructions are not semantically equivalent. While (4b) can be described as a simple action (with the subject *bees* performing the role of the agent), (4a) refers to a state resulting from the movement (*bees* having the role of the bearer of state/process). This semantic difference is closely connected with the 'holistic' vs. 'partitive' interpretation of the locative element (cf. Anderson, 1971). Example (4a) illustrates the 'holistic' interpretation of the locative subject, i.e. the whole area of the garden is affected by the movement, which actually constitutes a characteristic of the location; example (4b) illustrates the 'partitive' interpretation, i.e. only a part of the garden is affected by the bees' movement. The intransitive verbs which co-occur with a locative subject in the construction arising from the locative alternation can be grouped into the following semantic classes:

a. physical movements visually recognizable readily and at a 'small scale', usually found occurring repetitively (*crawl*, *drip*, *foam*, *heave*, *vibrate*, etc.);
b. animal sounds and other perceptually simple sounds (*hum*, *buzz*, *rustle*, *resound*, etc.);
c. conceptually simple visual perception of some kind of light emission (*beam*, *flame*, *glow*, *glisten*, etc.);
d. smells (*reek*, *smell*, *be fragrant*, etc.);
e. predicates indicating degree of occupancy or abundance (*abound*, *teem*, *be rich (with)*,[2] etc.) (Dowty, 2000: 115).

3. Czech translation correspondences of English presentative constructions

The various syntactic types of English presentative constructions can all be translated into Czech using the same construction: 'locative adverbial – verb – subject or object denoting a new phenomenon' (see Table 2). In most instances, the ordering of clause elements in the Czech counterpart can be seen to diverge from that in the English original sentence. In Czech, the primary factor determining the word order is the topic-focus articulation: given information tends to be presented at the beginning of a clause and new information at the end. Thus, the clause-initial Czech adverbial (typically expressed by a prepositional phrase, e.g. *před námi*, *na*

2. The examples given by Dowty (2000) involve not only verbal predicates but also copular predications (*be fragrant*, *be rich/rife/rampant (with)*).

stromě) provides the locative setting; the new phenomenon presented on the locative scene occurs in post-verbal position, functioning as the subject or object of the clause.

Table 1. Czech translation correspondences of English presentative constructions[3]

	English presentative construction		Czech counterpart
i.	full presentative constructions	*There's **a long trip** ahead of us.*	*Před námi je **dlouhá cesta**.* "Ahead of us is a long trip."
ii.	bare presentative constructions	a. ***A long trip** is ahead of us.* b. *Ahead of us is **a long trip** .*	*Před námi je **dlouhá cesta**.* "Ahead of us is a long trip."
iii.	*have* presentative constructions	*We have **a long trip** ahead of us.*	*Před sebou máme **dlouhou cestu.*** "Ahead of us we have a long trip."
iv.	locative subject constructions	a. *The tree has **a nest** in it.*	a. *Na stromě je **hnízdo**.* "In the tree is a nest."
		b. *The second page carried only **a few words**: …*	b. *Na druhém listu bylo jen **několik slov**:…* "On the second page were a few words…"
		c. *The airport was … swarming with **people**.*	c. *Na letišti bylo … **plno lidí**.* "At the airport were … many people."

4. Material and method

The study relies on contrastive (Czech-English) and monolingual (English) data. The source of the data is the Czech/English fiction sub-corpus of the bi-directional parallel corpus *InterCorp* (version 9).[4] In the initial part of the study (Step 1), the material is drawn from the Czech original fiction texts (2 708 811 tokens, 26 books) and their English translations. The monolingual part of the research (Step 2) is based on original English fiction texts which constitute the core of the English sec-

3. The new phenomenon presented on the locative scene is given in bold.

4. Corpus InterCorp: Rosen, A. – Vavřín, M. (2016) Corpus InterCorp – Czech/English, version 9. Praha: Ústav Českého národního korpusu FF UK. Available from http://www.korpus.cz

tion of *InterCorp* (15 821 092 tokens, 134 books). The fiction core of the *InterCorp* corpus comprises complete books published mostly between 1950 and 2010.

The present study takes the Czech presentative construction with the clause-initial locative adverbial (see Table 1) as its starting point to track among its translation counterparts various English patterns which perform the same presentative function. We aim not only at describing the translation correspondences but also at making predictions about what English syntactic constructions are likely to occur as implementations of the given semantic pattern (cf. Gast, 2015: 5). To achieve this, the contrastive cross-linguistic approach is combined with a monolingual one, focussing on English original texts only.

We can assume that while languages generally have identical "needs of expression and communication… the means of expression vary from language to language" (Mathesius, 1936: 95; cf. also Haspelmath, 2010, Martinková, 2014). The functional concept of 'presentation', shared by both Czech and English, can therefore serve as a *tertium comparationis*.

Since the Czech construction with a clause-initial locative element typically performs the function of presenting a new phenomenon on the scene, the question of how 'presentation' is expressed in English can be operationalised as 'What English constructions serve as functional correspondences of the presentative Czech sentences (i.e. as their translation counterparts)?' (cf. Gast, 2015).

Accordingly, we employ the Czech clause-initial locative adverbials as potential markers or anchors (Malá, 2013; Gast, 2015) of the presentative function. This allows us to identify among the English translation correspondences of the Czech presentative clauses various types of syntactic constructions whose function is to present a new phenomenon on the locative scene. Among these, we decided to explore only the sentences with a locative subject (type iv. in Table 1), which have not received so much attention in literature as the other types of presentative constructions (types i.–iii. in Table 1), perhaps also due to their lower frequency.[5]

The study therefore focuses on syntactically divergent translation counterparts (Johansson, 2007) of Czech adverbials, namely on the correspondences between a Czech adverbial and an English subject. As pointed out by Dušková

5. The translation correspondence between the Czech clause-initial space adverbial and the English locative subject is quite rare. The Czech adverbial is most frequently translated into English by a space adverbial, clause-initial or post-verbal, e.g. *Na rtech slečny Barbory se objevil slabý úsměv…* ("On Miss Barbara's lips appeared a faint smile…") – *A faint smile had appeared on Miss Barbara' s lips…* The English counterparts also include existential *there*-constructions, further attesting to the presentative character of the Czech sentences, e.g. *Ve staré přístavní čtvrti stál dům, který byl vestavěný do zříceniny kláštera.* ("In the old harbour quarter stood a house that was built into the ruins of a cloister.") – *In the old quarter by the harbour there was a house built into the ruins of a cloister.*

(1999b: 254), "if an adverbial is to be convertible into the subject it must be a potential participant in the verbal action and its form must be such as to allow the concomitant formal changes." To comply with the first requirement, only adverbials integrated in the clause structure were considered. The form of the adverbial was restricted to prepositional phrases as the nominal complement of the preposition may be converted into the subject of the corresponding English clause. Czech prepositions occurring frequently in locative uses, i.e. *do* ("into"), *na* ("at/on"), *v/ve* ("in"), *z/ze* ("from") (cf. Klégr et al., 2012: 18) were chosen as the starting point.

A two-step procedure was adopted in the excerption and analysis of the data (see Figure 1). In the first step, we proceeded from Czech sentences with initial locative adverbials (realised by prepositional phrases) to their English translation counterparts. The query was formulated so as to search for: a. sentence-initial prepositions *do*, *na*, v/ve, z/ze (6,200 concordance lines, i.e. 2,126.6 instances per million words), and b. the same prepositions in clause initial position followed by a relative pronoun (*který*, *jenž* and their gender-specific forms; 1,934 instances, i.e. 663.36 instances per million words). Since the corpus is not parsed, finding the relevant concordances, i.e. those pairs of sentences where the Czech adverbial prepositional phrase corresponds to the subject of the English clause, required manual sorting.

147 pairs of original Czech sentences and their English translations complying with the above criteria were excerpted (Step 1a in Figure 1).[6] The English sentences were analysed with respect to their syntactic structure, semantic roles of clause elements and – in particular – the semantics of the verb, since it is the verb which was found to act as the core of the presentative pattern (Step 1b in Figure 1).

In the second step, the occurrences of all the lexical verbs and copular predicates (i.e. the copula + its predicative complement) identified in step one as potential carriers of the presentative function were examined in English original texts in *InterCorp*. The second step does not aim at describing all the patterns in which these verbs were attested and their relative representation. It focuses merely on those instances where the verb is used to introduce a new phenomenon on the scene established by the locative subject. Among the various uses of the verbs, the 'presentative semantic pattern' represents "what is often said, not how… [the verb] is typically used" (Hunston, 2008: 291). In other words, what we focus on is not the frequency of the presentative pattern of the particular verb but rather the presen-

6. The Czech prepositions which express predominantly position in space or on surface, *na* ("at/on") and *v/ve* ("in"), proved to be the most useful starting points, yielding 62 and 71 English translation counterparts with locative subjects, respectively. The representation of the other space prepositions *z/ze* ("from") and *do* ("into"), which indicate direction, was marginal among the counterparts of English locative subjects, with 11 and 3 occurrences, respectively.

tative potential of the verb. The identification of the presentative uses of the above verbs extended the limited amount of data available as a result of step one, thereby making it possible to describe the presentative pattern in more detail.

The approaches adopted in the two steps of the analysis complement each other: the first step is more structure-to-lexis oriented (Hunston, 2015: 202), leading to the identification of lexical items which may then be used, in step two, as the starting point. Step two proceeds from these lexical items (presentation verbs) towards the identification of lexico-grammatical patterns which are then described as instantiations of an underlying semantic pattern.

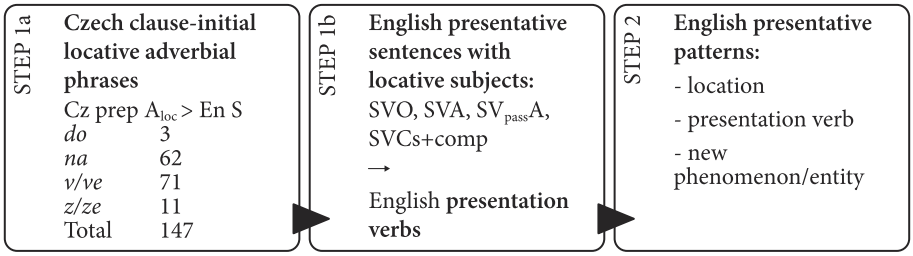

Figure 1. The cross-linguistic method of identifying the presentative semantic pattern

5. Analysis

5.1 Step one: From Czech to English

The following section examines the English translation counterparts of Czech sentences with clause-initial locative adverbials realized by prepositional phrases. The analysis of the translation counterparts of the Czech sentences revealed four different English presentative patterns with a locative subject (see Table 2). Two of these patterns, i.e. patterns 'subject-verb-object' (SVO) and 'subject-verb-adverbial' (SVA), have already been described in literature as presentative. In addition, we identified two new patterns with a presentative function, viz. the patterns 'subject-passive verb-adverbial' ($SV_{pass}A$) and 'subject-copular verb-subject complement+complementation of the adjective' (SVCs $_{(+comp)}$). Thus, the results suggest that even verbs in the passive voice and copular verbs may perform the presentative function. The patterns with locative subjects will be dealt with below in the order in which they are presented in Table 2.

Table 2. English clause patterns with locative subjects

Czech sentence	English translation counterpart	English pattern	No.
Na každé židli je nápis. "On every chair is an inscription." Na tváři měl klidnej úsměv. "On the face he had a peaceful smile."	Every chair had an inscription. His face wore a peaceful smile.	SVO	94
V očích jí zářila klidná radost. "In her eyes glowed peaceful joy."	Her eyes glowed with peaceful joy.	SVA	16
Na zdech byly zajímavé obrazy… "On the walls were interesting pictures…"	The walls were hung with interesting pictures…	$SV_{pass}A$	23
V jejich tvářích byla skutečná zloba. "In their faces was real anger."	Their faces were full of real anger.	$SVCs_{(+comp)}$	14
		Total	**147**

5.1.1 *The transitive verb pattern (SVO)*

As was expected on the basis of previous research, the transitive pattern SVO represents the most frequent English presentative pattern with a locative subject (64 per cent of sentences with the locative subject).

From the semantic point of view, the English subject denotes location of where the state/process takes place, the object can be described as the bearer of the state/process, and the verb expresses a kind of state or process (5a). The verb *have* has a presentative function, expressing the existence of a new phenomenon (*an inscription*), at a particular location (*every chair*).

The English verbs in the SVO pattern seem to fall into two semantic classes. The first class can be described as 'contain / be covered'[7] verbs. The most frequent verb in this class is the verb *have* (21 instances, example (5a)). In this construction, *have* is "stripped of its possessive meaning and is actually semantically emptied in this sense" (Adam, 2013: 149). The fact that these SVO sentences are instances of presentative constructions, and that they can be thus viewed as "an alternative to the full presentative construction" (Ebeling, 2000: 227) can be manifested by a paraphrase using the full presentative *there*-construction (5b). As was pointed out by Ebeling (ibid.) the main difference between this pattern and the full and bare

7. Levin (1993: 119) classifies the verbs as "*fill* verbs". The verbs in our sample can be more specifically described as 'contain / be covered' verbs, presenting the process from the point of view of the locative subject which 'is covered' by or 'contains' an entity.

presentative constructions is "the overt involvement in the existential process of person or thing". This person or thing is constructed as the subject here.

(5) a. Every chair *had* an inscription.[8]
Na každé židli je nápis.
"On every chair is an inscription."
b. There was an inscription on every chair.

Our examples also contain other verbs which have already been described in the literature as verbs of 'existence or appearance on the scene': *bear* (6), *wear* (7), *hold* and *contain* (8) (see Breivik, 1983: 246). The verb *house* (9) appears to be similar to these verbs. It should be pointed out that verbs which fall in the 'contain / be covered' class form a cline from the most semantically empty verb *have* to the verbs of more specific meaning, expressing "abstract relationships of containment, involvement and the like" (Halliday, 2004: 246), e.g. *contain, house, wear*. The semantic weakness of the verbs in examples (5)–(8) is underlined by their correspondence with the semantically empty verbs *být* ("be") and *mít* ("have") in the Czech original sentences.

(6) The fashionable T-shirt covering her well-formed chest *bore* a chartreuse message…
Na módním tričku, pokrývajícím dobře vzrostlou hruď, měla jedovatě zelený nápis…
"On the fashionable T-shirt… she had a chartreuse message…"

(7) His face *wore* a peaceful smile.
Na tváři měl klidnej úsměv.
"On his face he had a peaceful smile."

(8) The white envelope *contained* a brief letter from Kral, our local millionaire…
V bílé obálce byl krátký dopis od místního milionáře Krále…
"In the white envelope was a short letter…"

(9) A dusty display case used to *house* a set of fancy shot glasses from Moscow.
V zaprášený vitríně stálo pár zdobenejch moskevskejch stakanů.
"In the dusty display case stood several fancy shot Moscow glasses."

The second semantic class of verbs in the SVO pattern comprises verbs which may be described as 'manifestation verbs'.[9] All these verbs are related to sensory perception since the message is perceived through senses, e.g. *show* (13 instances,

8. Since we focus on English patterns, the English translation counterparts are listed before the original Czech sentences in the examples.

9. This category label was suggested to us by Martin Adam (personal communication).

example (10a)), *display* (6 instances, example (11)), *read* (2 instances, example (12)), *say* (3 instances, example (13)), *betray* (4 instances, example (14)), *give off, radiate, echo.*

(10) a. The photograph *showed* a naked child on a sheepskin rug.
Na fotce bylo děťátko pasoucí ovce.
"In the photograph was a child…"
b. There was a naked child on a sheepskin rug in the photograph.

(11) The next page *displayed* a large wedding picture…
Na další stránce se zaskvěla veliká svatební fotka…
"On the next page gleamed a large wedding photograph…"

(12) The sign *read*: Do not enter, this door is self-entering.
Na tabulce bylo napsáno: Nevstupovat, vstupuje samo!
"On the sign it was written: Do not enter, it enters itself!"

(13) He sent … two letters for me. One *said* he was doing well…,
V jednom stálo, že se má dobře…
"In one it said that…"

(14) His voice *betrayed* not the slightest regret.
V jeho hlase nebyl sebemenší náznak pokání.
"In his voice was not the slightest hint of regret."

'Manifestation verbs' related to sensory perception are semantically similar to *have*, the main difference being that their meaning is more specific and more closely related to the meaning of the subject. The subject of these verbs can be described as "a piece of paper, wood or metal that has writing or a picture on it that gives you information, instructions, a warning".[10] The verbs then link the subject with the object which denotes an inalienable part of the subject (e.g. the *naked child* cannot be removed from *the photograph* in example (10). This semantic connection between the subject and the verb is clearly illustrated in examples (10)–(12) (*photograph – show, page – display, sign – read*).[11]

Since the meaning of the verb is already implied in the subject denoting the location, the object represents the new piece of information, i.e. the new phenomenon presented on the locative scene. The presentational nature of the construc-

10. Definition of *sign*: http://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com/definition/english/sign_1?q=sign (Accessed 1 August 2017).

11. A similar semantic connection between the verb and its subject may occasionally be found also in the SVA pattern, e.g. *The virtuoso's voice rings with uncounterfeited astonishment*. (InterCorp)

tion can again be supported by the acceptability of the paraphrase using the full presentative *there*-construction (10b).

In three instances of the SVO pattern the locative reference is expressed twice in the sentence (15)–(16), once in the locative subject and once in the prepositional phrase, where the subject and the prepositional phrase are clearly co-referential. "The doubled expression of the locative reference" (Adam, 2013: 149) has the function of specifying location[12] and it is found with the verb *have* only.

(15) The table *had* a lamp *on it*.
Na stolku stála rozsvícená lampa…
"On the table stood a lit lamp…"

(16) …the corrals didn't *have* any trees *in them*.
V ohradách nebyly žádné stromy.
"In the corrals were no trees."

5.1.2 *The intransitive verb pattern (SVA)*

The analysis revealed 16 instances of the intransitive pattern SVA, which is a construction described in literature as resulting from the locative alternation. Similarly to the SVO pattern, the subject denotes location of where the state/process takes place, the verb expresses a kind of state or process, and the postverbal element, i.e. the adverbial, is the new phenomenon or entity.

The verbs in this pattern can be classified into several semantic types which correspond to those listed as being typical of the construction with a locative subject (Dowty, 2000: 115; Panevová et al., 2014: 123): light emission (*glow* in example (17)), physical movement, typically occurring repetitively (*swarm* in example (18)), animal and other sounds (*buzz* in example (19)), smells and tastes (*reek* in example (20)). The presentative interpretation of the SVA sentences with a locative subject can be supported by paraphrases using the full presentative constructions with the verbs *be* and *have*, examples (17b) and (c), respectively):

(17) a. Her eyes *glowed* with … peaceful joy.
V očích jí zářila … klidná radost.
"In her eyes glowed… peaceful joy."
b. There was peaceful joy in her eyes.
c. Her eyes had peaceful joy in them.

12. Freeze (1992: 583) and Ebeling (2000: 229) point out that some sentences are grammatical only with the prepositional phrase (e.g. *The tree has a nest in it*.). In other sentences with *have*, especially those where the object is "a characteristically associated noun (i.e. treated as inalienably possessed […])" the prepositional phrase is not used, e.g. *The tree has branches*.

(18) The country *was swarming* with innumerable doughty foes of Communism.
Ve vlasti se vyrojily mraky čackých bojovníků proti komunismu.
"In the country were swarming clouds of doughty opponents of Communism."

(19) My head stopped *buzzing* with words and I tried to speak to him kindly.
V hlavě mi přestala hučet slova a já k němu zkusil promluvit laskavě.
"In my head stopped buzzing words…"

(20) The boy's breath *reeked* of alcohol.
Z chlapcova dechu odporně páchl alkohol.
"From the boy's breath reeked alcohol."

All the examples clearly illustrate the 'holistic' interpretation of the locative subject: the subjects (*eyes*, *country*, *head* etc.) carry the semantic role of location, which "is attributed a distinctive property, namely a sensory effect generated by the stimulus [i.e. the phenomenon/entity] and thoroughly affecting the place" (Fried, 2005: 492). In compliance with Dowty's (2000: 117) observations, the adverbial typically comprises a plural or an uncountable noun (e.g. *words* in (19) and *alcohol* in (20), respectively). As regards its semantics, the noun denotes "an unquantifiable secondary agent (a mere instrument)" (Fried, 2005: 493). Interestingly, the original Czech sentences do not display the holistic effect; the holistic meaning is added only in the English translation.

5.1.3 *The passive verb pattern ($SV_{pass}A$)*

The English presentative constructions with a locative subject described in literature are always (to our knowledge) in the active voice. However, our analysis revealed that the locative subject is found not only in active, but also in passive constructions (23 instances, example 21a).

(21) a. The walls *were hung* with interesting pictures…
Na zdech byly zajímavé obrazy…
"On the walls were interesting pictures…"
b. There were interesting pictures (hanging) on the walls.

In the presentative passive constructions, the subject denotes the locative setting (*the walls*), the post-verbal prepositional phrase (*with interesting pictures*) expresses the new phenomenon which is presented within the space of the walls through the presentation verb in the passive (*were hung*). This interpretation can also be illustrated by the possible paraphrase using the full presentative *there-* construction (21b), which may serve as a test of the presentative function, as shown in the previous patterns.

The verbs in the $SV_{pass}A$ pattern fall into the same semantic class as the verbs pertaining to the active transitive SVO pattern (see 5.1.1), viz. 'contain / be covered'

verbs. They include: *be bathed, coated, covered, decorated, dotted, filled, hung, inscribed, jammed, swathed* (*with/in*) (examples (22)–(24)).

(22) The room *was filled with* a dim and oppressive twilight…
V pokoji panovalo dusné a temné přítmí…
"In the room reigned a stifling and dim twilight…"

(23) The kitchen table *was covered with* baggies of powder.
Na kuchyňským stole byly plastikový balíčky s řezanikem.
"On the kitchen table were plastic baggies of powder."

(24) Their greenish skins *were coated with* shiny insects and black flies.
V tý nazelenalý žluti byly závoje zářivýho hmyzu i černejch much.
"In the greenish yellow were coats of shiny insects and black flies."

In addition, the analysis revealed that in all $SV_{pass}A$ constructions the *by*-agent of the action is not expressed. Interestingly, the suppression of the agent can be seen as a relevant factor that is closely connected with the presentative function. Previous research has shown that the new phenomenon may appear on the scene "through some (unexpressed) external agency" (cf. Dušková, 2015: 264; Brůhová, 2015: 32). All the passive constructions have a stative meaning, denoting a state which results from the verbal action. Moreover, some of the passive constructions are non-agentive (22), i.e. "there seems to be no agency involved" (Dušková, 1999a: 120). In this respect they resemble the SVCs constructions. The whole of the location is affected ('covered' or 'filled') and attributed a certain property.

5.1.4 *The copular verb pattern (SVCs (+comp))*

The last English presentative clause pattern with a locative subject which was revealed as a translation counterpart of the Czech locative constructions is the copular pattern SVCs (14 instances) where the predicative adjective is further complemented by a prepositional phrase[13] (example 25). The subject (*their faces*) denotes the location, the copular predicate (*were full*) expresses a kind of state or process, having the presentative function, and the complement of the predicative adjective (*real anger*) represents the new phenomenon ushered on the locative scene.

Syntactically, as in all previous patterns the English locative subject corresponds to the Czech locative adverbial. Semantically, the role of the English subject may be described as a blend of locative and affected semantic roles. While

13. Without the prepositional phrase complementing the adjective, the copular verb pattern would not represent a presentative sentence (cf. *The theatre was full.*)

according to Quirk et al. (1985: 743) the subject of copular verbs is generally assigned the affected role, in these examples it also denotes a space which is characterised by the predicative complement.

(25) a. Their faces *were full* of real anger.
V jejich tvářích byla skutečná zloba.
"In their faces was real anger."
b. There was real anger in their faces.

(26) This realm *was alive* with all sorts of women.
Na tomto území se pohybovaly různé ženy.
"In this territory moved all sorts of women."

It is possible to view these sentences as one of the forms of presentation constructions, since their structure is very similar to the $SV_{pass}A$ pattern. Both SVCs and $SV_{pass}A$ patterns have a locative subject, a complex predicate (copular/auxiliary verb (*be*) plus a notional component – *full*, *filled*) and a clause-final prepositional phrase (usually *with*-prepositional phrase). In addition, the existential construction, which we have used as the test for the presentative function, is also acceptable with the $SVCs_{(+comp)}$ pattern (25b). Semantically, the copular predicates fit in the 'contain / be covered' class (*be + full (of), alive*, *crowded (with)*; *bathed*, *clad (in)*) or in the class of verbs of 'light/sound/smell emission or movement' (*aflame*, *fragrant*, *aglow* (*with*)). The most frequent predicative adjective is *full (of)* (7 instances), which carries very little meaning. Other adjectives have more specific meanings.

5.1.5 *Semantics of presentation verbs*

Section 5.1.1–4 have shown that the presentative function depends primarily on the semantics of the verb. All the verbs and copular predicates described above express simple non-actional and non-intentional processes which do not imply any change (cf. Kettnerová, 2014: 215). Although the range of English verbs which occurred in presentative constructions with a locative subject is relatively wide, we noticed that the verbs can be classified into three semantic groups:

a. 'contain / be covered' verbs (and copular predications), such as have, bear, contain, consist of, retain, wear, hold, house; be bathed, blotched, coated, covered, crowded, decorated, dotted, filled, hung, inscribed, jammed, swathed, piled, populated; be clad, full, fragrant, rich, aglow (with/in/of);
b. verbs of 'light/sound/smell emission or movement', such as buzz, hum, ring, glow, flash, sparkle, reek, bristle, drip, sprawl, swarm, twitch;
c. 'manifestation verbs' related to sensory perception, such as show, display, betray, depict, portray, radiate, read, speak of, say.

5.2 Step two: English original texts

5.2.1 *Verbs of 'light/sound/smell emission or movement'*

The second step of the analysis draws on a monolingual corpus of English original fiction texts (see Section 4). In this corpus, concordances of the verbs identified as potential carriers of the presentative function (see Section 5.1.5) were explored. For most of the verbs, the presentative function is not a dominant one. The presentative use of the verb is typically associated with the verb occurring in a particular lexico-grammatical pattern. Out of the 247 instances of the verb lemma *buzz* in the corpus, for instance, the verb is followed by the preposition *with* in twelve cases. It is only in this grammatical pattern that the presentative potential of the verb asserts itself.[14] The pattern is illustrated in Figure 2.

Figure 2. Buzz with

1	the house on Dean Street	buzzed	with *activity*.
2	a cluttered open area …, which was	buzzing	with *talk and laughter*.
3	Harry went to bed with his head	buzzing	with complex *spell models and theories*.
4	By that time the whole of Bree was	buzzing	with *excitement*.
5	But when I xited the Tiger-Lily,	buzzing	with *face-ache*,
6	The sub-ether was	buzzing	with *the communications*
7	The Trading Room, barometer of morale, is	buzzing	with *rumour*.
8	of hillsides	buzzing	with *heat*,
9	The place	buzzed	with *gossip and speculation*.
10	D-PAC	buzzed	with *unbridled energy*.

Relying on the concept of 'local grammar' (Hunston and Sinclair, 2000; Barnbrook, 2002; Bednarek, 2008; Hunston, 2013; Warren and Leung, 2016), meaning elements can be mapped on to the grammatical pattern. All the sentences in Figure 2 perform the action of introducing a new phenomenon into a particular location via the presentation verb *buzz*. The location (underlined) is typically either a space (e.g. lines 1, 2, 8) or a body-part (e.g. line 3). The phenomena introduced (in italics) through the process of *buzzing* comprise substances, activities and abstract qualities. They are all expressed by noncount or plural count nouns. The phenomena fill or cover the whole space and characterize it current state. The preposition *with* serves as a linking element, a 'hinge' (Barnbrook, 2002: 61).

14. The "desirability of taking pattern rather than word as the starting point for a local grammar" was pointed out, for example, by Hunston (2013: 150).

We assume that when "words are considered to belong to semantic sets, recurring patterns in their co-texts can be parsed to identify common semantic elements" (Hunston, 2013: 119). The verbs identified in Step one of the analysis as forming a class of 'light/sound/smell emission or movement' may indeed all appear in patterns that can be parsed in the same way as *buzz with* (Figure 3). Their presentative function is associated with the grammatical pattern 'V with n(pl/non-count)'. The subject can be assigned the functional label of location; the post-verbal adverbial represents the phenomenon or entity introduced on the locative scene. From the semantic point of view, the location is represented by a space or body-part, and the new phenomena comprise a variety of abstract qualities, activities, substances and, marginally, agents.[15]

These findings support Hunston's observation that "when words that shared both pattern and some semantic similarity were grouped together … it became apparent that functional rules could be mapped on to pattern elements with some consistency" (Hunston, 2013: 120).

5.2.2 *'Contain / be covered' and 'manifestation' verbs*

The concordance lines of 'manifestation verbs' and verbs and copular predications which constitute the 'contain / be covered' semantic set were examined in the same way as those of the 'light/sound/smell emission or movement' verbs. A grammatical pattern could be used as a starting point for a local grammar parsing in the case of verbs in the passive voice followed by a prepositional adverbial, e.g. *be bathed, coated, covered, decorated, dotted, filled, hung, inscribed, jammed* (*with*) (lines 1–2 in Figure 4). The same applies to the pattern with copular predications whose predicative complement is followed by a prepositional phrase, e.g. *aglow*, *fragrant*, *full*, *rich (with/in/of)* [16] (lines 3–5 in Figure 4). The parsing of these patterns is illustrated in Figure 4.

Starting from the grammatical pattern ('V-ed with n(pl/non-count)', 'Adj prep n(pl/non-count)'), further past participles and predicative adjectives can be identified which may potentially introduce new phenomena on a scene rep-

15. A grammatical restriction on countability and number applies here – the nouns are either non-count or plural. This is again connected with the holistic reading of the pattern, i.e. the whole location is affected and characterised by the introduction of the particular entity.

16. This is not to say that the grammatical pattern 'V-copula ADJECTIVE *with*' displays a one-to-one mapping on to local grammar elements. The semantics of the subject and the predicative adjective is crucial to the presentative function. The subject has to denote a location and the sense of the adjective has to fit the 'contain / be covered' class in the particular sentence (e.g. the copular predicate *was busy with* performs the presentative function in *About it the ground was busy with folk going to and fro…*, while no presentative function can be seen in *Madam Bones was busy with her briefcase…*).

Figure 3. The patterns of the verbs of 'light/sound/smell emission or movement'.

Syntax:	subject	verb		adverbial
Semantics:	space/ body-part	light/sound/smell emission or movement		activity / abstract quality / substance / agents
Local grammar:	location	presentation	hinge	new phenomenon/entity
1	house on Dean Street	buzzed	with	activity.
2	the kitchen	hummed	with	the pleasant clutter
3	The entrance hall	rang	with	laughter.
4	Her eyes	glowed	with	loving devotion
5	big green eyes that	flashed	with	either delight or rage.
6	His dazzling blue eyes	sparkled	with	inspirational zeal.
7	The bunkhouse	reeked	with[17]	the stench of death
8	The College of Cardinals	bristled	with	ebullience and electricity
9	Randolph 's voice	dripped	with	sarcasm.
10	The airport was hot and	swarming	with	people.

resented by the locative subject, such as *alive*, *busy*, *crowded*, *decorated*, *heavy*, *packed*, *thick*.

Apart from passive verbs, the semantic class of 'contain / be covered' verbs also comprises transitive verbs in the active voice in the syntactic pattern SVO (lines 6–10 in Figure 4). The grammatical pattern is too general to serve as a starting point of a local grammar parsing. To identify the instances of presentative use of these verbs, the locative semantics of the subject has to be taken into account. The starting point, therefore, is a 'semantic sequence' (Hunston 2008)[18] rather

17. With *reek* the preposition can be either *with* (6 occurrences) or *of* (35 instances, e.g. *I was sitting by her bedside in a room that reeked of iodine and bedpans, a hospital room.*)

18. Following Hunston (2008: 271–2), semantic sequences are understood here as "recurring sequences of words and phrases … characterised as sequences of meaning elements rather than as formal sequences. … The sequence will consist of the core word, the complementation pattern or patterns associated with that word …, and a number of phrase types occurring

than a grammatical pattern. The 'contain / be covered' verb (e.g. *bear*, *contain*, *hold*, *house*, *wear*) constitutes the core of the semantic sequence.

Figure 4. Parsing of the presentative pattern with 'contain / be covered' verbs

	location	presentation	hinge	new phenomenon/entity
1	The remaining walls	were covered	with	paintings and prints,
2	his heart	was filled	with	pity.
3	her eyes	were full	of	tears
4	The ceiling	was thick	with	cobwebs,
5	The sugar house	was aglow	with	light from the lanterns
6	Her face	bore	–	a half-mad expression
7	the place	held	–	answers for him.
8	His face	wore	–	a very ugly look indeed.
9	an area which	houses	–	every vice
10	The boat	contained	–	two policemen

The same approach to the identification of instances of the presentative semantic pattern was adopted in the case of the 'manifestation verbs' (e.g. *display*, *portray*, *radiate*, *read*, *say*, *show*). The entity presented in the situation is often an inscribed 'message' introduced on a locative scene represented by a piece of paper, wood etc. (Figure 5). Alternatively, the location can be a body part (*eyes*, *face*), which functions as the space where the 'message' is manifested.

Figure 5. Parsing of the presentative pattern with 'manifestation' verbs

	location	presentation	new phenomenon/entity
1	The painting	showed	a blue-robed Virgin Mary sitting with her arm
2	The screen	displayed	the bank's cruciform logo.
3	The mural	depicted	a tiny man in a red shirt held aloft in an elephant's
4	The decaying fresco	portrayed	Jesus and His disciples at the moment that Jesus
5	The card	read	'Lord Beale' and an address in Grosvenor Square.
6	The sign	reads	SIR ARTHUR CONAN DOYLE.
7	The note	said:	'You're a good guy, but I think I'll do it alone.
8	Langdon's blue eyes	showed	panic now
9	The father's face	revealed	horror, incredulity.
10	Sophie's eyes	flashed	disbelief.

before the core word which are, in spite of being diverse in form, consistent in terms of meaning."

6. Conclusions

Our study has demonstrated that the potential of the sentence to introduce a new phenomenon or entity in discourse is primarily based on the presentation semantics of the verb. Three broad semantic sets of verbs and copular predications capable of performing the presentation function were identified: verbs of 'light/sound/smell emission or movement', 'contain / be covered' verbs and 'manifestation' verbs. All the presentation verbs can be characterised as expressing simple non-actional and non-intentional processes which do not imply any change. Generally, they can be considered semantically weak, since they contribute to the information conveyed by the sentence to a much lesser extent than their complements, their function being reduced to that of ushering a new phenomenon in the given location (space or a body-part). However, the presentation verbs form a cline from the most semantically empty verbs (*have*) to the verbs of more specific meaning (*contain, wear*, *reveal, swarm*).

At the general grammatical level, the verb determines what syntactic structure will be employed to implement the presentative semantic pattern. The study showed that apart from the syntactic presentation patterns treated in detail in literature, i.e. the bare presentative, full *there*-existential and *have*-presentative constructions, the presentative function can be performed by sentences with the grammatical patterns SVO (including verbs other than *have*), SVA, $SV_{pass}A$, and $SVCs_{(+comp)}$.

At a local grammar level, the presentative pattern always comprises, apart from the presentation performed by the verb, the location and the entity or phenomenon introduced on the locative scene. The new entity covers or fills the space, leading to a holistic interpretation of the pattern, i.e. the location is characterised or ascribed some quality by being associated with the entity: for instance, the whole of the *place* in example (27), corresponding to line 10 in Figure 2, is affected by the *gossip and speculation* introduced through the emission of a *buzzing* sound.

(27) The place buzzed with gossip and speculation.

The study supports Hunston's (2015: 214) claim that "it is the presence of the sequence of meanings that leads to the co-occurrence of lexis and grammar. In other words, … patterns are a by-product of frequently occurring semantic sequences." The presentative semantic sequence may be described more generally as a 'local grammar of presentation', with its elements assigned the functional labels of 'location – presentation – new phenomenon/entity'. While various grammatical realizations of the pattern were identified, the recurrent semantic pattern

that they share addresses the common social need to introduce new phenomena or entities in discourse, locating them in already known or identifiable spaces.

From the methodological point of view, the study demonstrates how the use of a parallel translation corpus makes it possible to by-pass one of the limitations of corpus-assisted approaches in that it allows the researcher to look for patterns of meaning, or semantic patterns, rather than formal sequences. Hunston (2008: 292–3) outlines three methods of identifying semantic sequences: "serendipity", "a targeted search based on a grammar pattern", and "a targeted search based on 'small words', that is, grammar words such as prepositions". We hope to have shown that this set of methodologies can be complemented by a contrastive cross-linguistic method, namely a targeted search based on semantic sets identified through translation.

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